

Initial Post

by Séba Daher - Monday, 4 May 2026, 4:56 AM

(Evidence: <https://www.my-course.co.uk/mod/forum/discuss.php?d=364222#p732819>)

Hancock et al. (2024) identify three mechanisms through which data and technology aggravate risks to fairness and accountability in maritime human rights investigations: geographical bias, misinterpretation of remote data, and surveillance misuse. Each can be examined through the module's risk frameworks.

On bias, automated tools dependent on Automatic Identification System data systematically exclude vessels that do not broadcast. Stoneburner et al. (2002) establish that meaningful risk assessment requires accurate system characterisation before any likelihood or impact rating is assigned; where underlying data are structurally incomplete, risk determinations inherit that incompleteness without signalling it.

Hubbard (2020) reinforces this concern, arguing that risk must be preserved as a vector quantity, keeping probability and magnitude of loss as separate dimensions. Collapsing them into a single automated flag prevents practitioners from interrogating the assumptions driving the classification, compounding the fairness problem Hancock et al. (2024) describe.

The design-phase failure is equally significant. Aven and Thekdi (2025) frame risk assessment as centred on activities, consequences, and associated uncertainties, with novel environments requiring precautionary reasoning rather than reliance on prior baselines. Stoneburner et al. (2002) identify system characterisation, including the people affected by the system, as the essential first step. Excluding communities from that step relocates risk onto them without their awareness, which is precisely the condition Hancock et al. (2024) document in their findings on fairness and agency.

References

Aven, T. and Thekdi, S. (2025) *Risk Science: An Introduction*. 3rd edn. Oxon: Routledge.

Hancock, J. et al. (2024) *Trouble at Sea: Data and digital technology challenges for maritime human rights concerns*, Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency, pp. 988-1001.

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Stoneburner, G., Goguen, A. and Feringa, A. (2002) *Risk Management Guide for Information Technology Systems*. SP 800-30. Gaithersburg, MD: National Institute of Standards and Technology.